Corpus Linguistics

Reading argument 7

Name: _____ ID: _____

Question 1 Section V

In Section V, the author presents examples (47)–(50): a passive verb, an unaccusative verb, a raising verb, and a raising adjective. What point does he make with these examples?

_____

① All four structures overtly mark NP movement with an auxiliary verb and a past participle.

② NP movement is involved in all four structures, but only the passive overtly marks it with be + en.

③ Only the unaccusative verb involves NP movement; the other three do not.

④ In all four structures, the NP moves from the subject position to the object position.

Question 2 Section V

(a) In your own words, explain Kellerman's "Reasonable Entity Principle" in one sentence.

(b) In 1–2 sentences, explain how this principle helps account for why L2 learners, but not native speakers, mark NP movement with *be* + *en* in unaccusative sentences.

(c) The author mentions Sanskrit, Albanian, and Choctaw. What is his purpose in doing so? Answer in one sentence.

Question 3 Section V

The author distinguishes two types of overgeneralization:

- **Weak (limited) overgeneralization:**
  the marking of NP movement stays *within a clause* (NP–be–Ven).
- **Strong (extended) overgeneralization:**
  the marking extends *across a clause boundary* (NP–be–Ven–to infinitive).

Classify each sentence as **Weak** or **Strong**.

(i) *My mother was died when I was just a baby.* *weak / strong*

(ii) *English poems were seemed to be more personal.* *weak / strong*

(iii) *He was arrived early.* *weak / strong*

(iv) *The Chinese poems are seemed to be more sophisticated.* *weak / strong*

Then explain in one sentence why the *seem* examples ((ii) and (iv)) are difficult to account for with the causativization analysis.

Question 4 Section VI

Decide whether each statement about Section VI is True (T) or False (F).

(i) The author concludes that every actual production of a "passive" unaccusative in learner English can be explained by the movement-marker analysis. _____

(ii) The author claims that all target-English structures that show unaccusativity are equally prone to overgeneralization in L2 English. _____

(iii) The author admits that the corpus lacked enough data from L1 French, German, and Dutch speakers to test the transfer account fully. _____

(iv) The author points out that most previous studies on "passive" unaccusatives were based on naturally produced learner data. _____